WEEK 09

Functions, filters and tests

Python foundations

Functions, filters and tests

Predicates, result lists and independent tests

A predicate asks a question

Its Boolean result decides whether an item belongs.

```
def positive(n): return n > 0
print(positive(0))  # False
```

Filtering builds a result

Keep matching values without changing the source list.

```
values = [-1, 0, 2]
kept = [n for n in values if n > 0]  # [2]
```

Tests need independent expectations

A boundary case distinguishes > from >=.

```
def positive(n): return n > 0
assert positive(0) is False
```

A chore list answers a precise question

Question: which enabled chores are unfinished?

Chore	enabled	finished	Select?
A	**True**	**False**	**Yes**
B	True	True	No
C	False	False	No

Result: ["A"]

```
row["enabled"] and not row["finished"]
```

The result is a new list; the original records stay unchanged.

Syntax to read and reuse

Python / syntax	Meaning	When to use it
def feature(inputs):	Give the change a boundary	Make behavior callable
[x for x in rows if ...]	Filter a collection	Choose the intended records
assert actual == expected	Compare against a prediction	Expose a wrong implementation
check.assertEqual(a, b)	Assert with unittest	Reuse checks in a test module

Python Basics · sections 07, 10, 15, 17 · use only when you need a lookup.

Make one predicate from one record

```
def needs_work(row):
    return row["enabled"] and not row["finished"]

row = {"enabled": True, "finished": False, "published": False}
print(needs_work(row))
assert needs_work(row) is True
```

1. A predicate returns a Boolean.

Build a new result instead of changing input

```
numbers = [1, 2, 3]
selected = []
for number in numbers:
    if number >= 2:
        selected.append(number)
print(selected)
print(numbers)
assert numbers == [1, 2, 3]
```

1. A new result list leaves the input unchanged.

Keep an independent before snapshot

```
01 import copy
02 records = [{"points": 1}]
03 alias = records
04 before = copy.deepcopy(records)
05 records[0]["points"] = 9
06 print(alias[0]["points"], before[0]["points"])
07 assert before == [{"points": 1}]
```

1. A second name such as alias still refers to the original object.

Check a boundary and filter a small collection

```
def at_least(value, minimum):
    return value >= minimum
for value in (4, 5, 6):
    print(value, at_least(value, 5))
records = [("A", False), ("B", True), ("C", False)]
pending = [name for name, finished in records if not finished]
print(pending)
```

1. Expected: 4 False; 5 True; 6 True; ['A', 'C'].
2. A predicate decides which values to keep.
3. Replace >= with >: which check should fail?

Find a boundary bug in a function

```
01 def before_label(portions, reviewed):
02     if not reviewed:
03         return "hold"
04     return "team" if portions > 20 else "standard"
05
06 print(before_label(20, True))  # Wrong: standard.
07 print(before_label(20, False)) # Correct: hold.
```

1. Trace the early return first.
2. Compare > with >= at equality.
3. Keep an independent expected result.

An exact-boundary input can expose a one-character bug.

Table-driven checks for a small patch

```
01 def pickup_label(portions, reviewed):
02     if not reviewed:
03         return "hold"
04     return "team" if portions >= 20 else "standard"
05
06 cases = [(19, True, "standard"), (20, True, "team"),
07          (21, True, "team"), (20, False, "hold")]
08 for portions, reviewed, expected in cases:
09     assert pickup_label(portions, reviewed) == expected
```

1. Each tuple supplies inputs and expectation.
2. The loop runs one check per tuple.
3. The first failing assert stops execution.

A table of cases checks the patch and preserved behavior.

List comprehensions: choose the right predicate

```
rows = [("D10", False, False),
        ("D11", True, False), ("D12", True, True)]
pending = [key for key, collected, delivered in rows
           if not collected]
wrong = [key for key, collected, delivered in rows
         if not delivered]
assert pending == ["D10"]
assert wrong == ["D10", "D11"]
print(pending, wrong)
```

1. Unpack each tuple into three names.
2. The if clause filters the result list.
3. Find the row that distinguishes the filters.

Changing a filter condition can change which items are included.

Import reusable code without running startup

```
from pickup_app import planned_portions

print(planned_portions(3, 3))
assert planned_portions(3, 3) == 9
# This import does not reserve or deliver anything.
```

1. Use the documented module location.
2. Tests can call a function directly.
3. Keep input/output work in the entry point.

Reusable code can be imported without starting the application.

unittest: assert a returned value

```
01 import unittest
02
03 def label(portions, reviewed):
04     if not reviewed:
05         return "hold"
06     return "team" if portions >= 20 else "standard"
07
08 check = unittest.TestCase()
09 check.assertEqual(label(20, True), "team")
10 check.assertEqual(label(20, False), "hold")
```

1. Import the actual function in your project tests
2. Retain independent expected labels
3. Add negative, failure and state-preservation cases

A test must execute an independent expectation, not remain skipped.

Hands-on practice

Week_09.ipynb · Session 2

Python practice

P1–P2 · Core

Two small programs with approach hints.

P3 · Core

A complete program with normal and edge-case tests.

P4–P5 · Optional

An application and a harder challenge.

P1–P3: your code, expected results and an explanation. P4–P5 are optional.

Project studio

Student-designed feature

The project need

1

Need

A volunteer needs to trust and reproduce the supplied result.

2

Operation

Run the supplied baseline, compare results and complete your notes.

3

Result

A volunteer can repeat the result and understand its limits.

Reproduce the baseline and explain one small decision in the existing notes.

Turn the need into an acceptance experiment

1

Need

Identify the coordinator decision and present difficulty.

2

Contract

Specify inputs, permitted action and observable output.

3

Cases

Predict a normal case and a distinguishing boundary or failure.

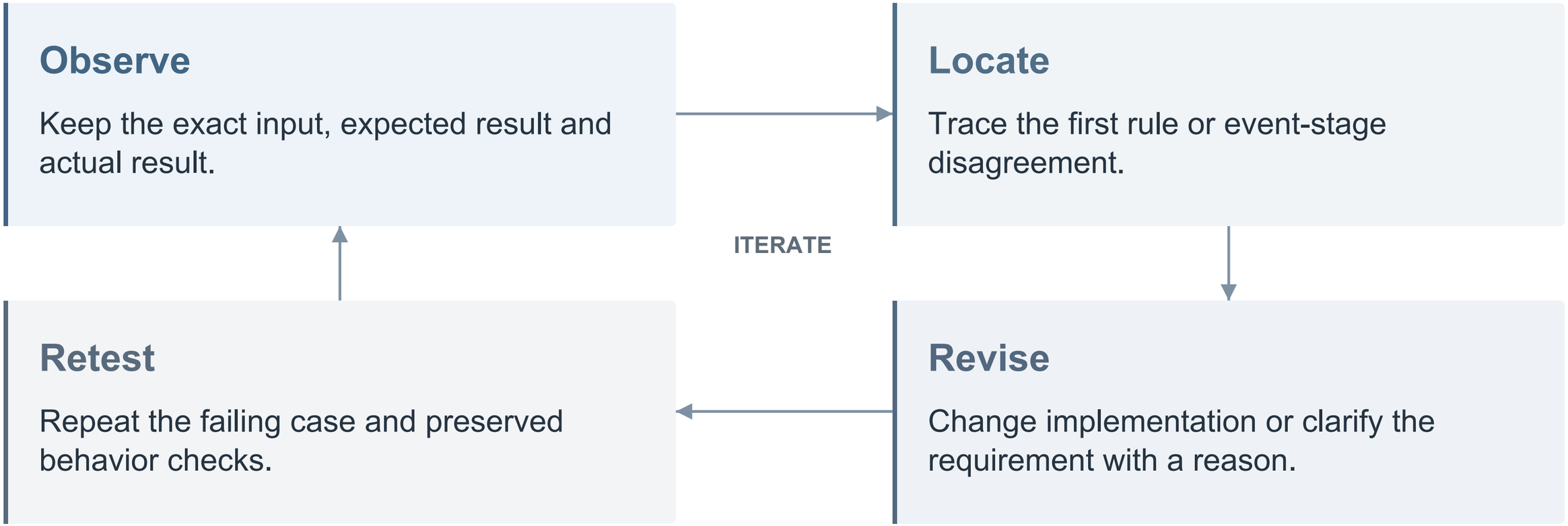
4

Evidence

Run independently and compare actual records and outputs.

Expected behavior comes from the need, not from the program output.

Optional improvement: use a failing observation



Implementation is optional; reproduction plus a reasoned decision remains required.

Project task

Supplied starting point

Baseline, fixtures and checks.
No new feature is required.

Required minimum

Reproduce the outputs.
Explain one reasoned decision.
Complete every requested note.

Optional extension

Propose an improvement, or
change one part in a separate copy.
Check and explain any change.

Keep one decision, two contrasting cases and honest evidence in the existing notes.

Project checks

Step	What to show
Reproduction	Supplied run, expected/observed results and completed notes.
Understanding	Explain your choice, alternative, tradeoff and two contrasting cases.
Peer check	A classmate follows your steps; keep the observation.

Reproduce the baseline and explain your decision; implementation is optional.

Further reading in English

1. ## Python unittest documentation

   https://docs.python.org/3/library/unittest.html

2. ## Google Engineering Practices: How to do a code review

   https://google.github.io/eng-practices/review/reviewer/

Read one relevant section, then bring an example and a question.